SPROUT 2.0

Small steps. Big dreams.

A mobile-first investing experience designed to make the first steps feel clearer, friendlier, and less intimidating.

PROJECT TYPE	PRIMARY PLATFORM
UI/UX concept • Fintech	Mobile-first, with desktop adaptation

Design direction

Warm cream backgrounds, mint surfaces, forest-green typography, restrained lime accents, rounded cards, and a friendly sprout mascot create an approachable visual language. The aim is simple rather than childish: welcoming enough for beginners, but clear about financial risk.

Prepared as a design case study. Prototype and research claims should be validated before any live product launch.

01 / The brief

Sprout 2.0 is a concept for an investing app aimed at first-time investors in India, with a proposed entry point from ■100 where the chosen product permits it. The experience should make the process understandable, guide users through identity verification, and communicate risk honestly.

Design challenge

How might we help a first-time investor understand what is needed, complete onboarding with confidence, and know what is happening while verification is in progress?

Core deliverables

• Mobile homepage with clear value proposition, CTA, how-it-works, document checklist, FAQs, and risk disclaimer.

• Five onboarding screens: welcome, documents needed, mobile/OTP, KYC, and verification waiting.

• Desktop homepage adaptation, mascot states, reusable style guide, clickable prototype, and this case study.

Scope note

This is a design concept, not a functioning investment service. Regulatory status, supported products, onboarding timings, and notification behavior must be confirmed by the product owner before release.

02 / Data audit & problem framing

The assignment brief supplies funnel and usability signals. They indicate where to investigate, but they do not establish a single proven cause for abandonment.

Signal from brief	What it suggests	Design response
78% bounce; paid ad traffic included	Traffic intent and landing-page relevance may differ by source.	Measure bounce by channel and align campaign promise with the page.
62% KYC drop-off; cause unknown	Do not assume one root cause; support mentions missing documents and a waiting screen that looks crashed.	Show required documents before KYC and make verification status explicit.
91% mobile; 40% on phones under ■10,000	Small screens and lower-end devices matter.	Use mobile-first layout, short copy, large tap targets, and lightweight visuals.
6.2 s load on 4G	Heavy assets may make the first interaction feel slow.	Limit large images and motion; test performance on budget devices.
Survey n=40 existing users	May not represent people who never invested or abandoned onboarding.	Interview new users and abandoners before treating themes as universal.

Funnel baseline from brief

40,000 downloads → 9,000 KYC starts/completions as labelled in the brief → 3,000 first investments. This equals 22.5% from downloads to the KYC milestone, 33.3% from KYC to first investment, and 7.5% from downloads to first investment. The exact KYC event definition should be confirmed before reporting.

Working hypothesis: clearer preparation guidance and transparent waiting states may reduce uncertainty. This is a hypothesis to test, not a proven result.

03 / Users & journey

Primary user: a first-time investor who wants to start small, needs plain-language guidance, and may not know which documents are required. This is a provisional persona derived from the assignment scenario, not a validated research persona.

Stage	User question	Design opportunity
Discover	Can I start with a small amount?	State the ■100 entry point accurately and make risk visible.
Prepare	What do I need before I begin?	Show PAN, Aadhaar, and linked mobile checklist early.
Sign up	Where will the OTP go?	Show +91, explain OTP delivery, and provide resend/error states.
Verify	Why are these details needed?	Explain KYC in plain language and identify fields clearly.
Wait	Is the app stuck?	Show in-progress status, what happens next, and honest timing.

Design principle

Reduce uncertainty at each step: tell users what is needed, why it is needed, what is happening now, and what they can do next.

04 / Visual design system

The visual language pairs friendly illustration with a calm, high-contrast interface. Color and rounded shapes add warmth; hierarchy and whitespace keep the experience usable.

Color palette

Forest	Mint	Cream	Lime	Charcoal
#174C3C	#DCEFE3	#F8F7F2	#C8F169	#252A27

Color	HEX	Use
Forest green	#174C3C	Primary actions, headings, links
Mint green	#DCEFE3	Hero panels, secondary surfaces
Warm cream	#F8F7F2	Main page background
Lime	#C8F169	Small highlights and icon accents
Charcoal	#252A27	Body text
Muted green	#5D6B63	Supporting text
Border	#E4E9E2	Card and input outlines

Typography & layout

• Typeface: Inter for UI; use a Hindi-ready font such as Noto Sans when Hindi copy is introduced.

• Desktop hero headline: 40–48 px; mobile hero: about 26 px; section headings: 20–24 px; body: 14–16 px; disclaimer: at least 12 px.

• Mobile frame: 390 × 844 px; desktop frame: 1440 px wide. Use consistent side margins, 8-point spacing increments, and generous section gaps.

• Cards: 14–20 px corner radius; buttons: 12 px radius; inputs: white fill with a 1 px #E4E9E2 border.

05 / Components & accessibility

Reusable components reduce visual drift across the homepage and onboarding flow. The following are the intended design rules for implementation.

Component specifications

Component	Specification
Primary button	Forest green fill #174C3C; white label; 48–52 px height; 12 px radius; minimum 44 × 44 px target.
Secondary link	Forest green text; clear label; sufficient spacing from primary action.
Text input	White fill; #E4E9E2 border; 48–52 px height; persistent label above field; clear error message.
Progress indicator	Show step number and progress; do not rely on color alone.
Disclaimer	At least 12 px, high contrast, full text visible above the fold on investment-related first screen.
Cards	White or mint surface; consistent radius; adequate internal padding and text spacing.

Accessibility and inclusion checklist

• Target WCAG AA contrast; verify actual text/background combinations with a contrast checker.

• Use 44 px or larger touch targets and avoid tightly packed controls.

• Keep language plain, labels persistent, and errors actionable.

• Design layouts that can expand for Hindi text; use auto-width buttons with padding rather than fixed-width labels.

• Respect reduced-motion preferences; avoid motion that blocks comprehension.

• Optimize images and animation for lower-end devices and slower 4G connections.

• Keep all risk wording visible and never imply returns are guaranteed, safe, or risk-free.

Asset and performance constraints

The brief sets a page budget below 1.5 MB and animations below 100 KB. Treat these as implementation acceptance criteria: compress raster imagery, prefer lightweight SVG where suitable, and measure the exported page rather than assuming the target has been met.

06 / Mascot sheet

Sprout acts as a consistent guide rather than a decorative character. The same core silhouette, leaf shape, face style, and color treatment should carry across screens.

01 — Welcome

Open smile; inviting posture. Use on welcome and homepage.

02 — Guiding

Friendly pointing or presenting gesture. Use beside checklists.

03 — Waiting

Calm, patient expression. Use on verification-in-progress screen.

04 — Celebrating

Happy expression with restrained sparkles. Use after verified success.

Expression rules

• Keep the face, body proportions, leaf shape, and shading consistent.

• Use expressions to support the task: welcome, explain, reassure, celebrate.

• Do not use celebration during a pending or failed verification state.

• Provide alt text for meaningful mascot images and keep text instructions available without the illustration.

• Use lightweight assets; avoid adding decorative animation that competes with the primary action.

Figma note

Place four states on one 800 × 600 px frame titled “Sprout — Mascot Sheet”. Use a 2 × 2 card grid, labels, and the same mascot asset or closely matched variants. The cards above document the intended states; they are not final rendered mascot artwork.

07 / Prototype flow

The prototype should demonstrate the main path from discovery to verification waiting, plus basic error and success states. Connect the existing Figma frames rather than drawing a new flow from scratch.

From	Interaction	To
Mobile homepage	Tap Get started	Onboarding 01 — Welcome
Welcome	Tap Continue	Onboarding 02 — What you need
What you need	Tap I’m ready	Onboarding 03 — Mobile / OTP
Mobile / OTP	Tap Send OTP / Continue	Onboarding 04 — KYC
KYC	Tap Submit for verification	Onboarding 05 — Waiting
Waiting	Tap Notify me (prototype only)	Show confirmation or stay on waiting state
Waiting	Verification completed (demo path)	Success state: You’re verified

Figma interaction setup

• Select the CTA layer or button group, open the Prototype tab, and drag the connector node to the destination frame.

• Use “On click” → “Navigate to” and a consistent transition such as Instant or Smart Animate where layers match.

• Connect secondary links where required; set the homepage or Welcome frame as the flow starting point.

• Create separate variant frames for OTP error, KYC validation error, expanded “Why we ask”, and verification success if time permits.

• Test the prototype using Present mode at a phone-sized viewport; check back navigation and ensure no CTA leads to the wrong frame.

Prototype limitation

Figma connections are demonstrations only. OTP delivery, KYC verification, reminders, notifications, and investment transactions are not functional unless separately implemented and integrated.

08 / Success metrics & validation

The proposed design should be evaluated with usability tests and funnel instrumentation. The following are suggested measures, not achieved results.

Metric	Why it matters	How to measure
Homepage → Get started CTR	Checks whether the value proposition is clear.	Clicks / eligible homepage sessions
KYC start-to-completion rate	Tracks progress through identity verification.	Completed KYC / KYC starts
Time to locate required documents	Tests checklist usefulness.	Moderated task timing
Waiting-screen confusion rate	Checks whether status is understood.	Ask users what is happening; track repeated exits/support contacts
First investment conversion	Measures completion of the intended journey.	First investments / eligible completed KYC users
Performance on budget phones	Validates inclusion and speed constraints.	Load time and task success on low-end devices over 4G

Suggested validation plan

• Test with 5–8 first-time investors, including people who have not completed KYC before.

• Include users on budget Android devices and test under constrained network conditions.

• Ask participants to explain the required documents, why KYC is requested, and what the waiting screen means.

• Compare completion and confusion rates before and after changes; avoid claiming causality without enough data.

• Test Hindi expansion and screen-reader/contrast behavior before launch.

Expected learning

The key question is not whether the interface looks friendly, but whether people can accurately explain the next step, prepare the right documents, understand risk, and distinguish a normal verification wait from an app failure.

09 / Design decisions & next steps

Decision log

Decision	Rationale / trade-off
Mobile-first layout	91% of traffic is mobile in the brief; design for narrow screens and budget devices first.
Document checklist before KYC	Addresses support themes about PAN/Aadhaar not being ready without claiming they explain all drop-off.
Explicit waiting state	Responds to reports that the waiting screen looks crashed; timing must be based on verified service data.
Plain-language KYC explanation	Makes the purpose of identity verification understandable at the point of need.
Risk disclaimer visible early	Keeps financial risk visible rather than hiding it in the footer only.
Mascot as guide	Adds warmth at key moments while keeping task instructions explicit and accessible.

What remains before production

• Confirm the legal entity, regulatory claims, and applicable investment product details.

• Replace timing placeholders with observed service-level data; ensure notification claims match actual functionality.

• Run contrast checks and accessibility tests against final exported screens.

• Compress images and measure page/animation weight against the brief's limits.

• Conduct usability testing, revise based on findings, and document what changed.

• Verify that all Figma screens, prototype connections, and submission permissions work.

Closing

Sprout’s design direction is built around a simple promise: help beginners take the next step with more clarity, not more pressure. A friendly visual system can make the journey approachable, while transparent risk communication, accessible interactions, and honest status updates make it more trustworthy.

Submission checklist

• Figma file shared with “Anyone with the link can view” (if permitted by the assignment).

• Export this case study as PDF and verify page order/readability.

• Test the prototype link and confirm it opens at the intended starting screen.

• Remove placeholders and unverified claims before final submission.